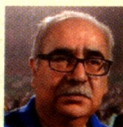


PURUSHOTAM DIWAKAR/www.indiatodayimages.com

It's One Big Happy IPL Family



SURESH CHELLARAM, co-owner of Rajasthan Royals, is Lalit Modi's brother-in-law.



GAURAV BURMAN, whose Elephant Capital picked up a 50 per cent stake in GCV, is Lalit Modi's stepson-in-law.

GCV is the exclusive worldwide online and mobile broadcast licensee of IPL, its official website partner as well as its official television and online broadcast rights holder for North America, through Willow TV, which Elephant Capital has acquired.



MOHIT BURMAN, co-owner of Kings XI, is Gaurav Burman's brother.



N. SRINIVASAN, BCCI Secretary, is MD of India Cements which owns the Chennai Super Kings



AMAR BINDRA, son of IPL governing council member I.S. Bindra, is Kings XI cricket operations consultant



K. SRIKANTH, chairman of BCCI national selectors, is the brand ambassador for Chennai Super Kings



MEHR JESSIA'S event management company Face One manages the IPL after-parties. She's the

wife of Arjun Rampal, one of Shah Rukh Khan's closest friends.



POORNA PATEL, Praful Patel's daughter, is IPL's head of hospitality.



franchises and all of Modi's linkages with them. As counter-argument, Modi's men have maintained that all they wanted to do was get the godly details about the owners of the Kochi franchise. The reason for making persistent questions, was based, they said, on a simple principle. "Suppose one of the owners turns out to be a bookie," one of the IPL men said in sinister sotto voce. "Two things can dismantle the league—betting and the unknown owner."

When the IPL's first eight team franchises were awarded, the governing council was given details of their ownership. Council member MAK Pataudi says, "I don't think there's anyone in the original eight teams who we didn't know of. The information that wasn't there was about the exact division of the ownership. But I would say we knew 99.9 per cent of the people behind the first eight teams."

The details of one of the two new teams caused a stir when Modi listed Kochi's stake-holding on Twitter. It peeved the most sceptical of his governing council partners—BCCI President

Shashank Manohar and Secretary N. Srinivasan, even though the IPL is embedded with conflict of interest. Srinivasan, who will take over as BCCI president in a few months, is owner of Chennai Super Kings, BCCI secretary and IPL Governing Council member. The IPL's foundation stone bears the invisible legend: your friend's friend is my business partner. Its woodwork crawls with Modi's own kinsmen and fellow travellers, so it is ironic that Tharoor should be on the mat for his "friendship" with Sunanda Pushkar, who has part of a 25 per cent free equity of the Kochi franchise through Rendezvous Sports World.

Modi's cheerleaders are of course greeting this latest Clash of the Titans (a sequel to his Season 2 contest with P. Chidambaram) as proof of his growing national importance. But he may want to look over his shoulder at the government's proposed plan of scrutinising the ownership details of all IPL teams, in particular the Rajasthan Royals.

But it has not been called the Indian Parivar League for nothing. For